"All the News That's Fit to Print"

# The New York Times

THE WEATHER
**Today,** mostly cloudy, warm for early November, high 69. **Tonight,** mainly clear, patchy fog, warm, low 56. **Tomorrow,** sunny, warm, high 71. Weather map appears on Page A20.

VOL. CLXXVI .... No. 61,057 © 2026 The New York Times Company TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00

# *Economic Worries Sharpen as Midterm Campaign Ends*

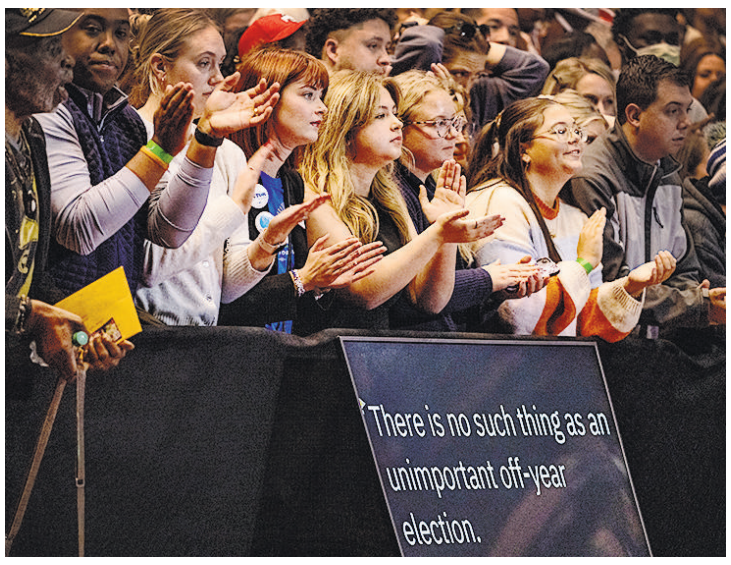



HAIYUN JIANG/THE NEW YORK TIMES




HAIYUN JIANG/THE NEW YORK TIMES

**TEXAS** A homemade sign supporting Ken Paxton, who faced James Talarico, above, in one of the most costly Senate races in history.




VICTOR J. BLUE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

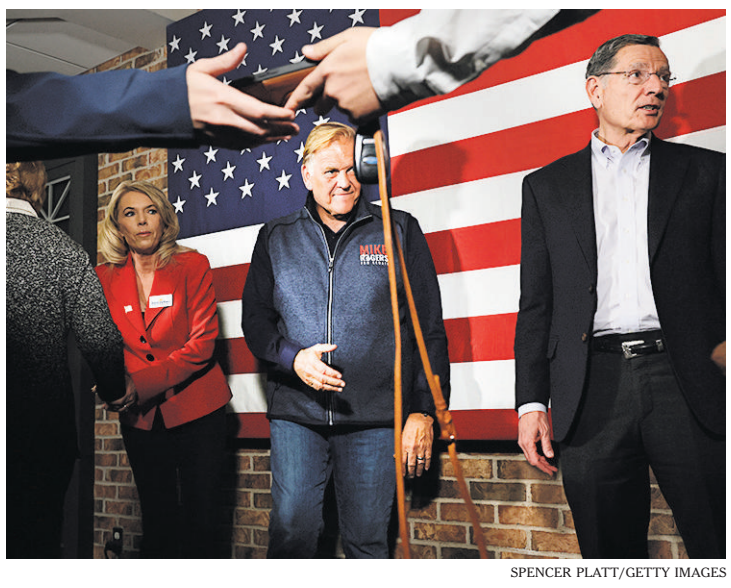



MADDIE McGARVEY FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

**OHIO** Barack Obama rallied Democrats in the state, where Vivek Ramaswamy was locked in a battle for governor with Amy Acton.




TODD HEISLER/THE NEW YORK TIMES



SPENCER PLATT/GETTY IMAGES

**MICHIGAN** Abdul El-Sayed lost the backing of the Democrat he beat in the primary as he clashed with Mike Rogers for a Senate seat.

## *Republicans Stress Strong Indicators as Democrats Fault Trump Policies*

By LISA LERER and ALAN RAPPEPORT

DALLAS — Financial concerns have been the most pressing issue for voters in four of the six previous midterm elections of this century. But with the war in Iran and tariffs driving up gas prices, inflation and mortgage rates, the worries feel deeper, more desperate and decidedly center stage in the final days of the hard-fought campaign that will decide control of Congress.

Democrats are hammering President Trump for starting a war with Iran and instituting tariffs that have driven up prices, while Republicans are insisting the fundamentals of the economy are stronger than before they took power two years ago. And polls show that pocketbook issues are once again top of mind for many voters.

If presidential elections are about a vision for the future, midterms give voters a chance to offer their verdict on a president, a Congress and, almost always, the nation's economic health.

Over dozens of interviews across the country in recent days, Americans from across the political spectrum detailed the financial gymnastics of keeping pace with rent hikes and mounting utility bills, along with rising prices for gas, groceries and even Halloween candy. Many voters directly blamed Mr. Trump and his party for the high cost of living.

"The prices of everything we normally buy have gone up and up dramatically," said Dwayne Stanford, a father of eight in suburban Cincinnati, who chose only Democratic candidates during early voting in his state. "It's just the everyday stuff."

"Everybody's feeling it in terms of inflation," said Bret Rhodus, 52, an independent voter from Douglas County, Kan. "College costs, because I'm kind of in that stage of life. But even, like, the price of a pizza."

"It's expensive," said Sophia Gallerani, 80, a retiree who said she cast her ballot for the Republican ticket on the first day of early voting in Tucson, Ariz. "Basic needs like eating and gas for getting to appointments if I have any or going to church."

The worries of voters, which cross lines of generation and gender, race and political ideology, reflect the anxieties of a country convinced that the American dream is slipping away. In polls, focus groups and interviews, voters said some promises of a middle-class life — health care, a college education, homeownership and retirement — were becoming rapidly unaffordable. They fear their children will live a worse life than they do.

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## *G.O.P. Faces Ire At Clampdown On Immigrants*

By JENNIFER MEDINA and JAZMINE ULLOA

President Trump returned to the White House calling for "mass deportations now," after anger over illegal immigration drove his voters to the polls in 2024. But two years later, amid high-profile raids and deadly ICE shootings, immigration politics have been scrambled once again, creating unpredictable fault lines in the hours leading up to Election Day.

Public polling suggests that voters are now more likely to trust Democrats on immigration policy, although Republican voters remain more motivated by the issue. And while some Latino voting-rights activists worry that recent immigration raids in California and elsewhere could suppress Hispanic turnout, others are optimistic that the opposite is true in some of the most competitive congressional districts in the country.

"Republicans are really out of step with where Americans are with immigration, just like how Democrats were out of step in 2024," said Senator Ruben Gallego, a Democrat who won in Arizona two years ago while calling for stricter immigration enforce-

*Continued on Page A16*

## With Sour Jabs, Vance Reveals Preview of '28

By ERICA L. GREEN

WASHINGTON — In mid-October, Vice President JD Vance came face to face with a young woman who told him that he got her vote when she cast her first ballot as a U.S. citizen. At a town hall in Michigan, she asked why he was scapegoating immigrants for the issues he had vowed to solve as vice president.

Mr. Vance responded that his goal was not to "dehumanize" immigrants.

"To the extent that my rhetoric has been imperfect here, that's on me," Mr. Vance said.

But days later, when a heckler interrupted his speech with shouts of "Release the Epstein files" and "God bless our children," Mr. Vance claimed without evidence that the man was an illegal immigrant.

And last week, at a rally in Michigan, Mr. Vance suggested that Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, a Muslim American and Democrat who is running in a tight race for the Senate, would lead an uprising similar to the unrest taking place in France.

"We have to understand what happens when our nation gives in

*Continued on Page A17*

## *The Final Arguments: Radicalism vs. Corruption*

By LISA LERER and THOMAS FULLER

Candidates raced to make their final arguments on Monday in a tumultuous midterm campaign defined by economic anxiety, a backlash to the Iran war and disapproval of President Trump's second-term agenda.

Speaking in front of the renovated Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool on Monday afternoon, Mr. Trump described the elections as the most important midterms "in our lifetime."

But in a speech full of digressions, he spent very little time discussing the stakes facing his party and the issues that have animated the campaigns.

### *With the Parties Trading Blows, the President Sees a 'Golden Age'*

He painted a picture of economic vitality, plentiful jobs, secure borders and billions of dollars of oil coming from the "conquest of Venezuela."

"This is the golden age of America," he said.

At the same time, Mr. Trump also seemed to acknowledge the headwinds facing the Republican Party on Tuesday. "For some reason, the sitting president doesn't win the midterms," he said.

Fearing deep losses across the country, Republicans have unleashed a flurry of attacks. They have cast their Democratic challengers as radical, dangerous and even anti-American. In Michigan, Republicans seized on a surprising last-minute endorsement of their nominee for the Senate, former Representative Mike Rogers,

*Continued on Page A10*

### More Election Coverage

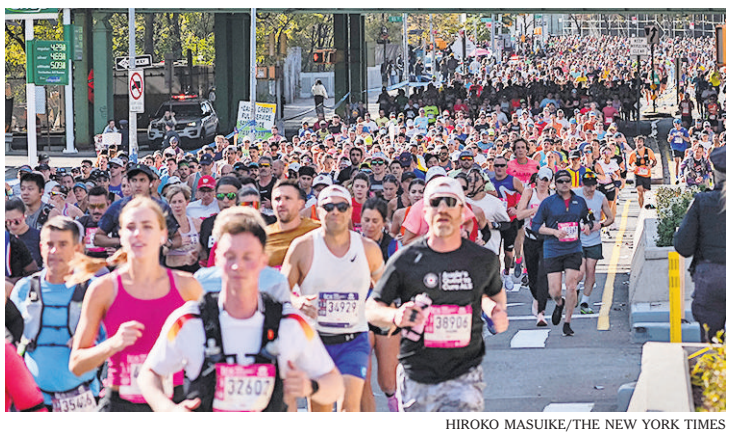
**FINAL POLLS** Democrats surged in almost all of the seven battleground states that will decide control of the Senate. PAGE A14

**MUSK'S BET** The tech leader has contributed $474 million in this cycle to help the G.O.P. PAGE A13

**TARIFFS ON BALLOT** Michigan voters are wary of free trade and of the president's policies. PAGE B1

### Follow Along on Tuesday

Reporters around the United States will provide midterm election results, real-time news, analysis and more at nytimes.com.



HIROKO MASUIKE/THE NEW YORK TIMES

### Finishing Touches

One last look back at the New York City Marathon, including a list of the more than 60,000 people who completed it. Section F.

## Israel's Inconclusive Vote Cues Long Battle to Pick Prime Minister

By AARON BOXERMAN

This week, Israeli party leaders will trickle into the residence of President Isaac Herzog to officially recommend their pick for Israel's next prime minister after the inconclusive election last Tuesday.

In two days of livestreamed meetings set to begin on Wednesday, politicians from 11 parties, including those representing secular liberals, ultra-Orthodox Jews and Arab voters, will make their case to Mr. Herzog. He will then bestow the mandate to build a coalition on whichever candidate he deems the most viable, who will have up to six weeks to form a government.

Most party leaders are expected to back Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, the longtime right-wing leader, or his main rival, the center-right politician Gadi Eisenkot. Neither man's party won a clear 61-seat majority in balloting for the 120-member Parliament, probably meaning that weeks or months of negotiations among the parties and elected lawmakers lie ahead.

Behind the scenes, politicians are weighing the path forward

### It May Take Months of Wrangling Involving 11 Political Parties

and wrangling for the upper hand. With no one having emerged from the election with a decisive victory, Mr. Netanyahu, Mr. Eisenkot and the rest are left to cajole and squeeze opponents and would-be allies alike.

"It's a game of chicken," said Nevo Cohen, a political strategist who ran the 2022 election campaign for the far-right national security minister, Itamar Ben-Gvir.

Mr. Netanyahu has long exercised a tight grip over his bloc of conservative and religious parties. But some could always bolt — potentially, ultra-Orthodox or more moderate right-wingers in his own Likud faction — in exchange for influence in an Eisenkot-led government, political analysts said.

Mr. Eisenkot could also look to form a government by relying on Arab parties that have long sat on the sidelines of Israeli politics, or by teaming with Mr. Netanyahu to

*Continued on Page A6*

INTERNATIONAL A4-8

**Flying Aboard 'Shepherd One'**
Unlike American presidents, Pope Leo XIV has no private jet, so he travels on commercial airlines, like the rest of us. Well, almost. PAGE A4

**Conceding Election Losses**
Rejecting President Trump's playbook of denial, strongmen in Serbia and Hungary opted for retreat. PAGE A8

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**Test for Prediction Markets**
Betting sites can predict election results correctly, studies show. The midterms are a major proving ground. PAGE B1

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**Can You Afford to Watch TV?**
Television viewing now comes with a wide range of interesting options, but also with a sizable bill to pay. PAGE C1

**A 'Harryween' Farewell**
It was fitting that the last concert of Harry Styles's New York residency fell on an especially spirited holiday. PAGE C1




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**Californians Weigh Wealth Tax**
The outcome of the state's ballot initiative for a billionaires tax could set the tone for the broader Democratic debate about how to raise revenue. PAGE A9

**Young Lives on Doomed Jet**
A 20-year-old co-pilot and a family with children were among those killed when a Learjet crashed in Florida. PAGE A21

OBITUARIES B11-12

**A Father of Flat Screens**
Cyril Hilsum helped to develop the technology for liquid crystal displays. He was 101. PAGE B11

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**Case of the Missing Skulls**
Researchers are baffled by an unsettling discovery at a Stone Age farming settlement in Slovakia. PAGE D4

**Do-It-Yourself Astronomy**
Some people buy telescopes. Others who gather at a convention in Vermont build them from scratch. PAGE D8



SPORTS B7-10

**A Title That Pays Tribute**
The rollicking spirit of Bob Uecker helped the Brewers win a World Series he didn't live to see. PAGE B7

**On Top and Not Done**
The Golden State Valkyries, a second-year W.N.B.A. franchise, have the tools to contend for more titles. PAGE B10

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**Howell Raines** PAGE A22